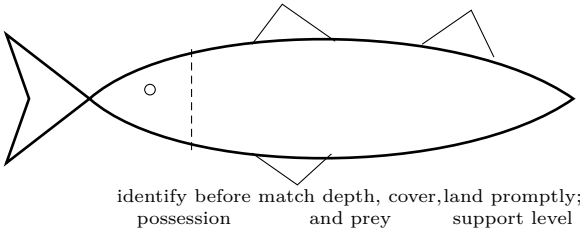


Recognize it	Lake role						
Green bass with dark lateral band; closed jaw extends beyond rear of eye. <table><tr><td>Body</td><td>Deep-bodied; first and second dorsal sections separated by a deep notch.</td></tr><tr><td>Mouth/fins</td><td>Very large mouth; tongue lacks a tooth patch.</td></tr><tr><td>Confusion</td><td>Smallmouth jaw ends near mid-eye and usually shows vertical bars.</td></tr></table>	Body	Deep-bodied; first and second dorsal sections separated by a deep notch.	Mouth/fins	Very large mouth; tongue lacks a tooth patch.	Confusion	Smallmouth jaw ends near mid-eye and usually shows vertical bars.	Where it belongs Vegetation, wood, docks, shade, and nearby depth. Food and season Fish, crayfish, and large invertebrates; shallow around warming cover, deeper or shaded in heat.
Body	Deep-bodied; first and second dorsal sections separated by a deep notch.						
Mouth/fins	Very large mouth; tongue lacks a tooth patch.						
Confusion	Smallmouth jaw ends near mid-eye and usually shows vertical bars.						

A fish-shaped decision, not a lure list



Find it on these waters

Pine	Test protected vegetation and shade, then the deep edge in clear midday conditions.
North	Test weed flats, wood, narrows, and current-adjacent ambush edges.
Evidence	The DNR lake records sometimes name only a broad group such as panfish. In that case this species is a candidate member, not verified individual presence. Confirm presence before targeting; treat locations as testable habitat hypotheses, not abundance findings.

Presentations

1. **Weightless plastic.** Skip or pitch to holes and shade; let it fall on slack line and watch for movement.
2. **Texas rig.** Probe dense cover with enough weight for bottom contact, not more.
3. **Stop rule.** After several accurate casts without evidence, change cover type or depth before changing lure details.

HANDLING DECIDES THE OUTCOME

Land promptly, wet hands, support larger fish horizontally, and never hang a heavy fish by the jaw.

Water-specific rule	May 2, 2026–Mar 7, 2027; 14-in minimum; bass daily bag 5 combined on both lakes.
Kitchen choice	If harvested, favor a legal mid-size fish over a scarce trophy; larger adults are valuable spawners.
Before the trip	Open the Wisconsin DNR water-specific regulation page for WBIC 779200 (Pine) or 850800 (North). Check the exact water, species, and date; the live rule controls if this dated sheet differs.

Keep only a fish you can use

Decide before the cast. Bring ice, stop fishing when the planned meal is secured, and use the species-specific cooking guide for dispatch, bone layout, and safe preparation. Large old predators are valuable spawners and generally carry more mercury than smaller fish.

Sources checked 2026-07-26. Wisconsin DNR lake fish records (Pine WBIC 779200; North WBIC 850800), Wisconsin’s Fishes, Hook Your Catch, 2026–27 water-specific regulations, Catch-and-release Guidelines, and Eating Your Catch. Biological and tactical synthesis is editorial; it is not a current population survey.

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